Possession Across the World

Jonah Landow

Research Topic

- How important is controlling the ball to the outcome of a match across top leagues: Premier League, Ligue 1, Serie A, La Liga, Bundesliga, MLS

- Stylistically, I expect the correlation to be stronger in leagues such as Serie A and La Liga, while the MLS I expect to have less of an impact considering the physical and counter attacking nature of the league

Data retrieved from whoscored.com

Data Source

WhoScored.com EN Search Sign In | Sign Up

LIVE SCORES STATISTICS PREVIEWS NEWS TOP FACTS FREE BETS TELEGRAM Odds

Top Tournaments Favourites All Tournaments

Football Statistics

Detailed League Statistics All Team Statistics Comparison

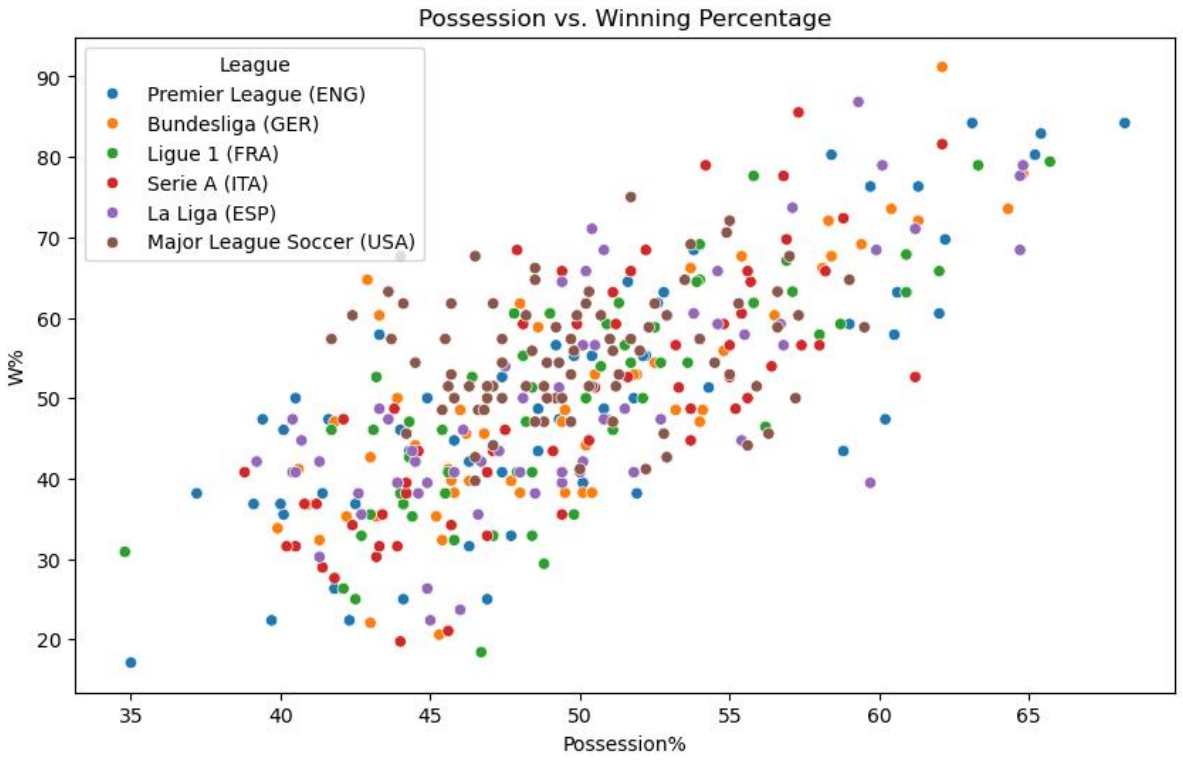
Team Statistics

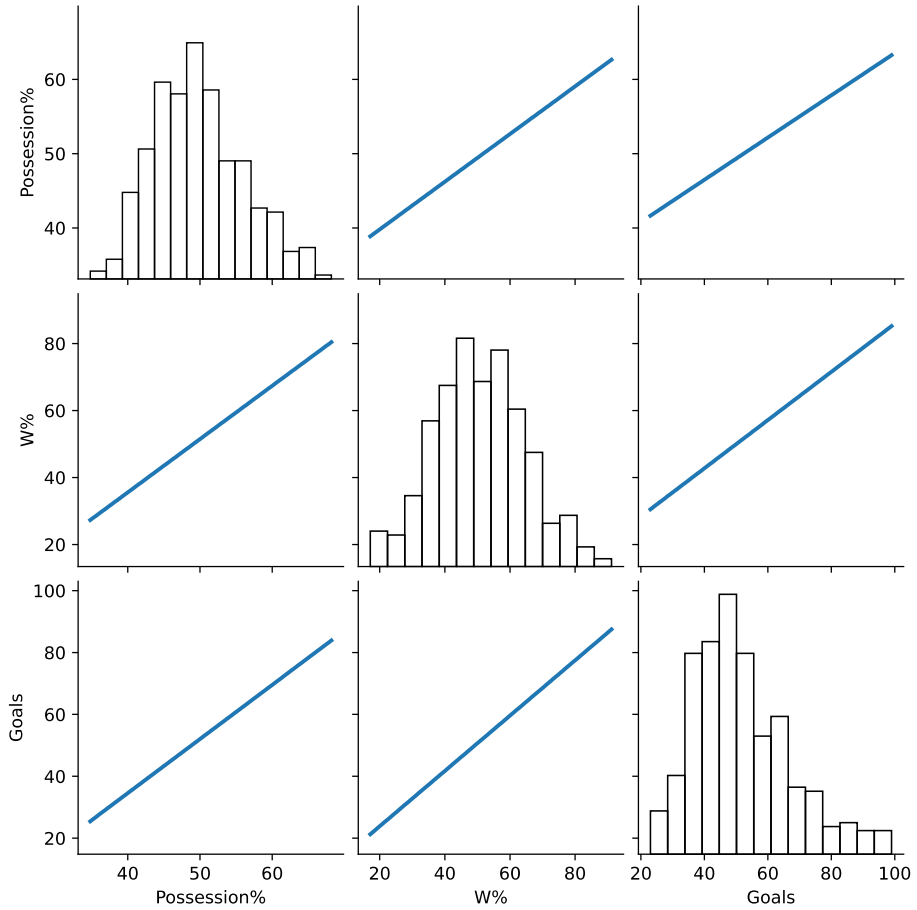
Summary Defensive Offensive xG Detailed

Overall Home Away

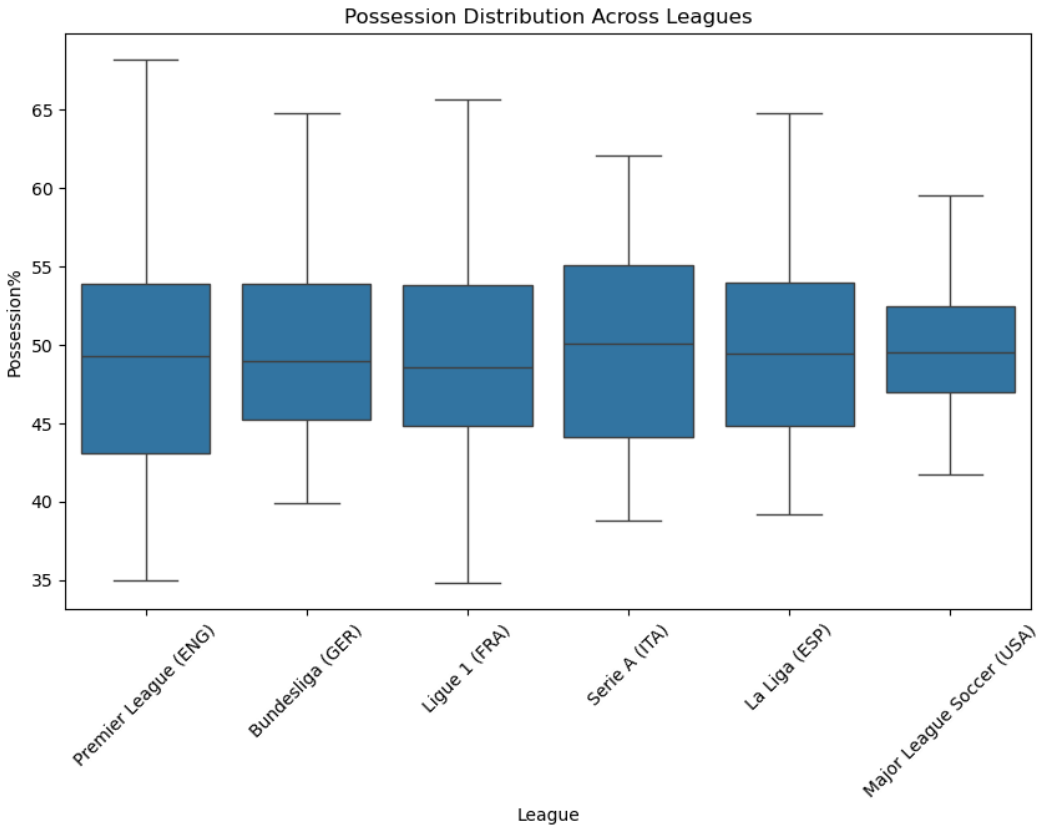
Team	Tournament	Goals	Shots pg	Discipline	Possession%	Pass%	AerialsWon	Rating
1. Paris Saint-Germain	Ligue 1	66	18.6	28 0	68.6	91.0	8.3	7.01
2. Bayern Munich	Bundesliga	72	19.1	38 0	69.0	90.2	12.3	7.00
3. Barcelona	LaLiga	71	17.2	43 3	67.8	88.0	10	6.88
4. Liverpool	Premier League	66	16.6	52 2	56.7	86.1	11.1	6.87
5. Real Madrid	LaLiga	55	16.4	41 3	61.4	90.0	8	6.87
6. Bayer Leverkusen	Bundesliga	55	16	40 1	58.7	87.2	13.1	6.80
7. Arsenal	Premier League	51	13.8	52 5	56.0	86.5	13.6	6.79
8. Inter	Serie A	60	15.4	36 0	59.7	88.1	16.6	6.79
9. Nice	Ligue 1	49	13.8	42 3	47.1	83.9	12.6	6.79
10. Atalanta	Serie A	59	14.8	48 0	56.9	86.0	15.8	6.78
11. Bournemouth	Premier League	45	15.9	68 1	46.9	79.1	14.8	6.76
12. Monaco	Ligue 1	48	15.3	39 3	56.1	83.4	13.1	6.76
13. Eintracht Frankfurt	Bundesliga	50	14.9	35 1	48.3	83.7	12.6	6.74
14. Manchester City	Premier League	53	16.3	44 1	60.6	90.1	7.9	6.74
15. Mainz 05	Bundesliga	39	11.6	54 3	49.5	77.7	19.3	6.74

At a glance

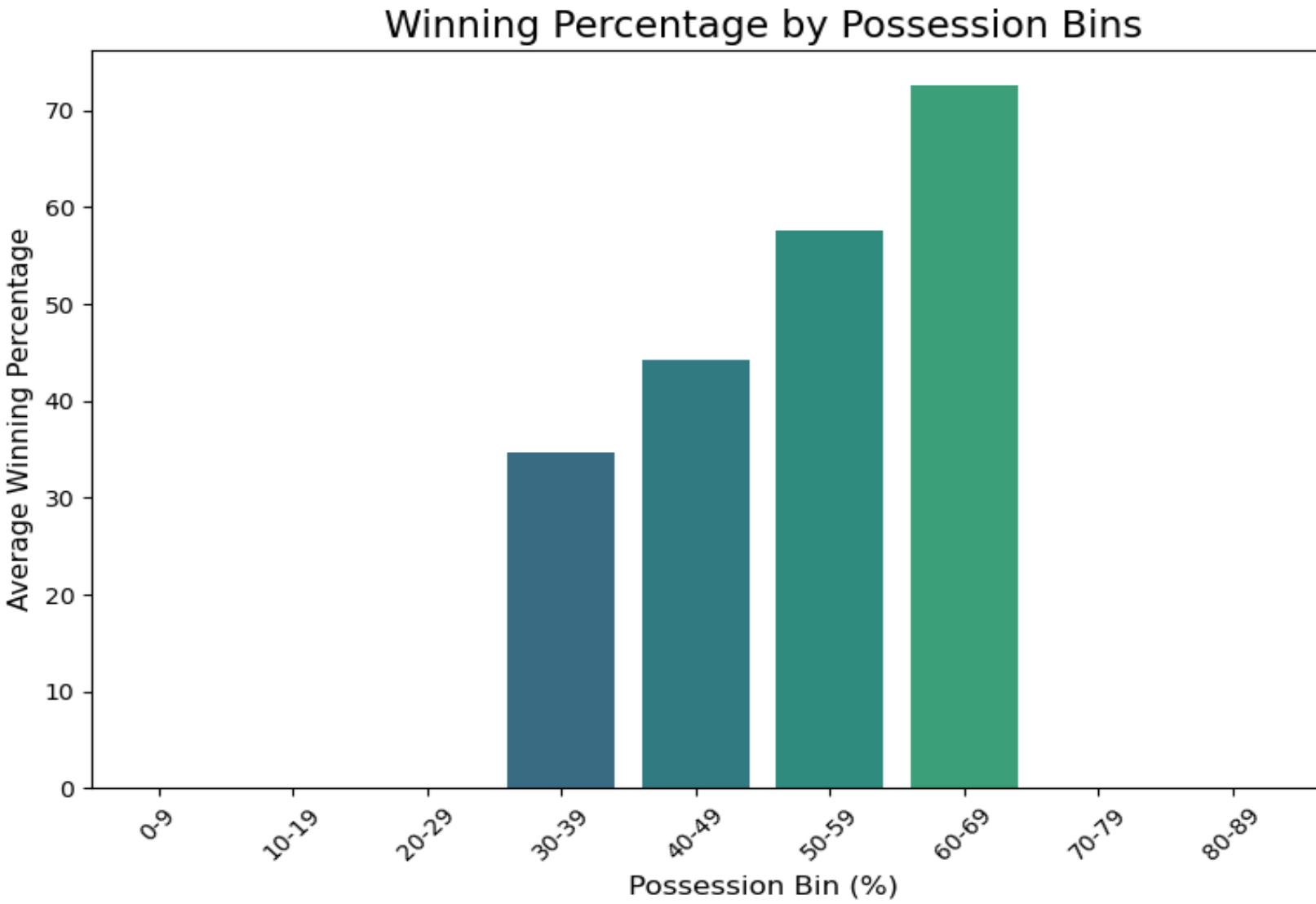

Possession vs. Winning Percentage
League
Premier League (ENG)
Bundesliga (GER)
Ligue 1 (FRA)
Serie A (ITA)
La Liga (ESP)
Major League Soccer (USA)
W%
Possession%


Possession%
W%
Goals

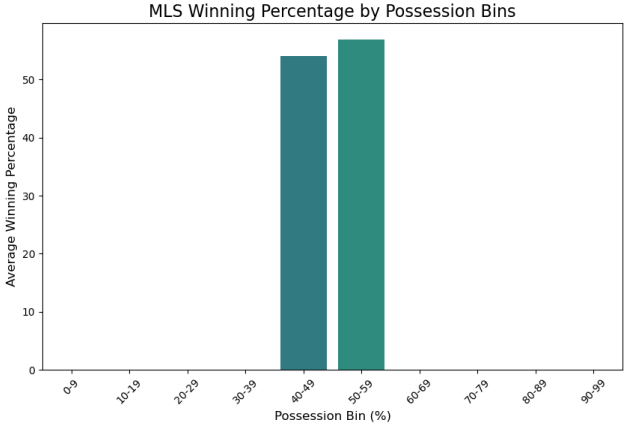
Wide Variety

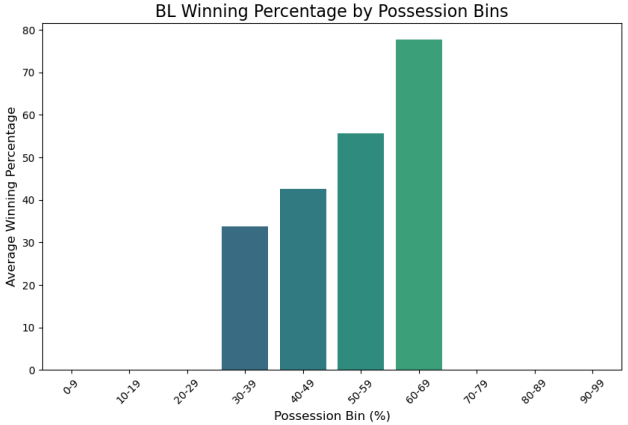


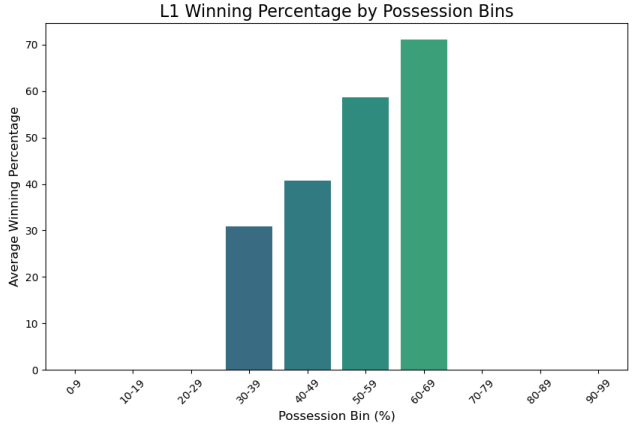
Possession = WINS

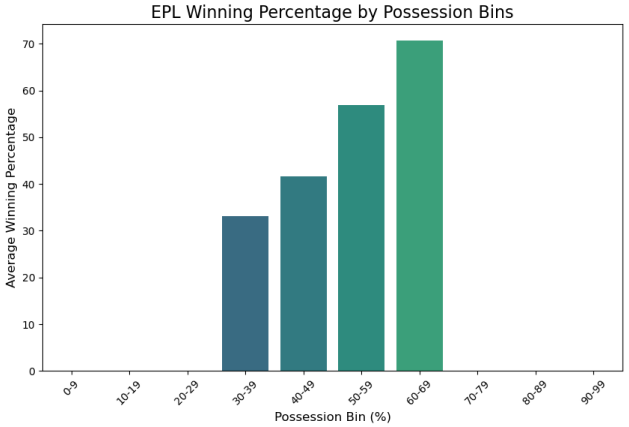


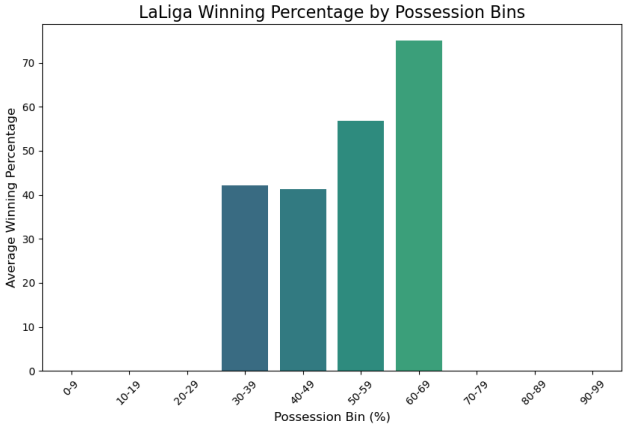
Just how much does it matter in each league

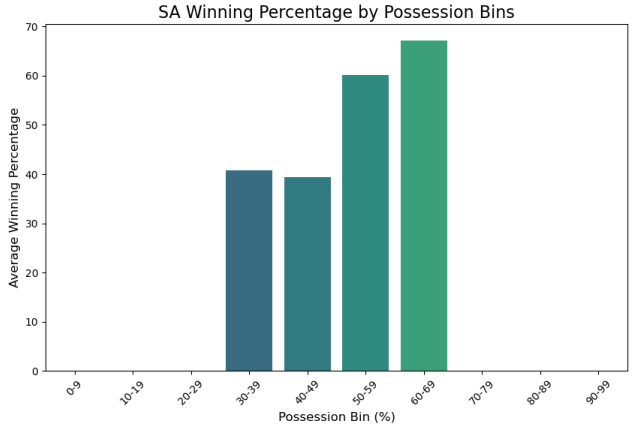


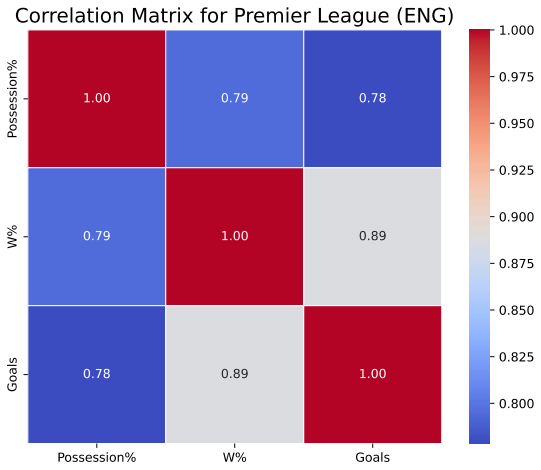


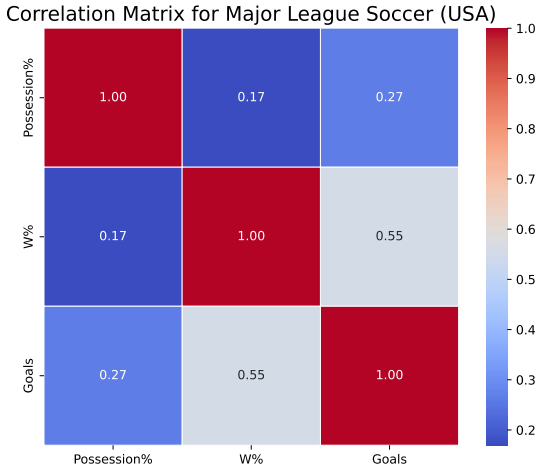


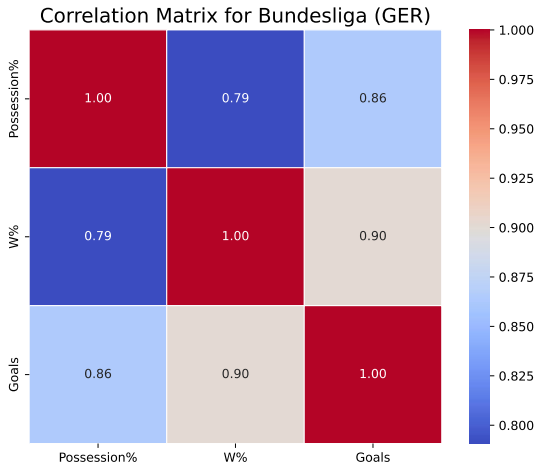


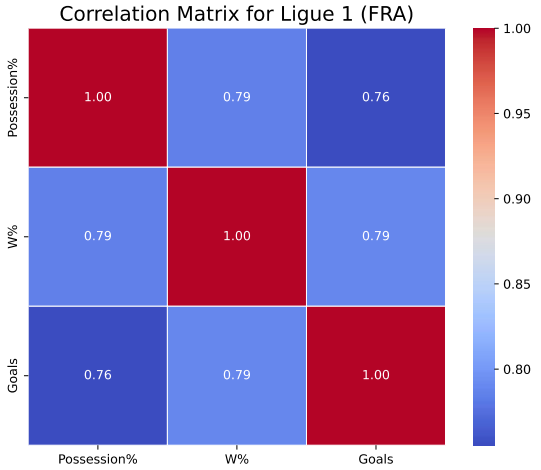


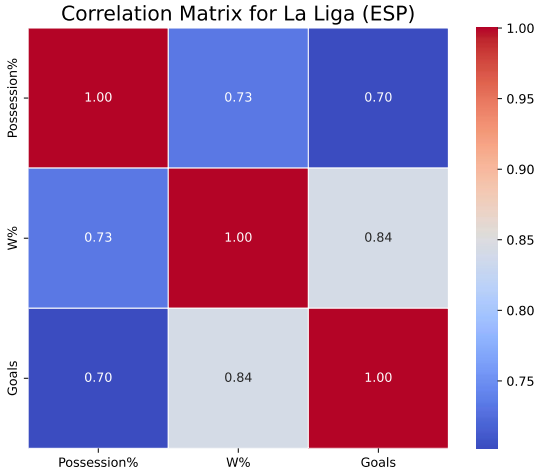


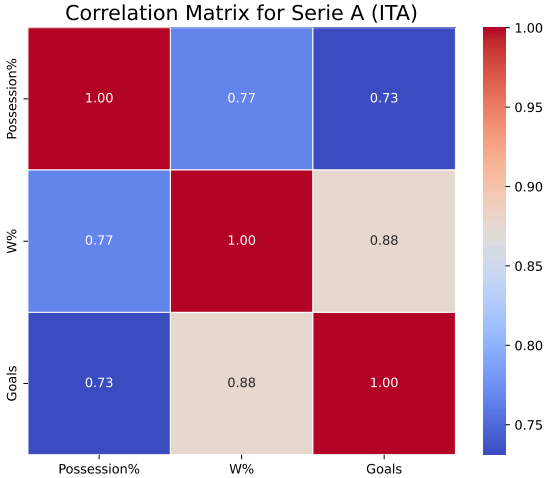












Correlation Heatmaps

- Key Findings:

Lowest: MLS - .17 correlation between possession and Winning

Highest: EPL/L1/Bundesliga - .79 correlation between possession and winning